The Quiet Calculus

Robust Decision, Embodied Calibration, and Cooperative Learning

A source-grounded scientific synthesis and research framework

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October 25, 2026 | Local manuscript, version 1.0

Abstract

Narrative can generate scientific questions without supplying scientific evidence. This paper extracts the scientifically relevant content of *Dune: The Quiet Calculus—Book I: First Cohort*, an 81-page campaign novelization, and translates it into an auditable framework for inference, constrained decision-making, embodied self-assessment, and cooperative education. A page-indexed catalogue distinguishes mathematical or methodological principles, empirical connections, untested hypotheses, normative choices, and fictional premises. The synthesis develops a sufficient robustness criterion for trajectories under bounded perturbations; a stochastic allocation formulation with an explicit confidentiality boundary; an estimate–measure–revise protocol for physiological calibration; and a cooperative mastery model with individually verifiable competence. It also specifies a factorial experiment for the narrative's proposed embodied-updating routine. Reproducible, deliberately small numerical examples illustrate robustness margins, proper probabilistic scoring, scheduling tradeoffs, and the fragility of all-or-none cohort certification. These examples establish only consequences of stated assumptions. No human participants, clinical outcomes, extraordinary physical observations, or efficacy data are reported. The contribution is a source-grounded synthesis and testable research agenda, rather than a new physical theory or a validation of fictional events.

Keywords: robust optimization; uncertainty; interoception; metacognition; cooperative learning; provenance; privacy; scientific inference.

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1 Introduction: from narrative to scientific questions

The source text [1] organizes its story around a repeated distinction: observations can constrain a model without making that model certain. Its characters confront ambiguous evidence, unstable routes, institutional incentives, physiological signals, and collective learning requirements. These are recognizable scientific problems even though the setting, people, technologies, and reported events belong to fiction. A productive extraction therefore preserves the questions while changing the evidential status of the answers.

Three contributions follow. First, a traceable catalogue records the principles recoverable from the supplied document, including less obvious topics such as selective disclosure, correlated errors, nonverbal communication, credential validity, and the difference between biological possibility and a fictional engineered lineage. Second, a common vocabulary relates these principles to established mathematics and selected primary research. Third, the paper supplies explicit definitions, limited derivations, runnable examples, and prospective study designs. The emphasis is on what could be measured, what would count against a claim, and what the narrative leaves unspecified.

The paper adopts *Zora Scientist* as an analytical working voice: curious, quantitative where possible, and explicit about evidential limits. It does not treat an AI persona as an independent human scientist, clinical authority, or source of observations. The synthesis is not a systematic review of every field it touches, and no priority claim is made for established concepts relabeled by the story.

2 Source, extraction, and claim classification

2.1 Corpus and page convention

The corpus is the single user-supplied PDF, titled *Dune: The Quiet Calculus—Book I: First Cohort*, attributed in its metadata and title page to Christopher Michael Baird and Zora. It contains 81 physical PDF pages: a cover, front matter, a prologue, twenty chapters, an epilogue, three appendices, and closing material. All 81 pages were included in extraction. The four largely illustrative pages were also visually inspected. Page references in this paper use **physical PDF page numbers**, so PDF page 2 is printed page 1. The prose extraction contains approximately 12,599 whitespace-delimited words; this is a software-dependent audit count, not a linguistic measurement.

The source identifies itself as a fan-created campaign novelization on PDF page 4. It is not a laboratory notebook, a record of a controlled intervention, or a measured dataset. Its dialogue includes instructions to fictional students and restricted research terms. Those passages are objects of analysis; they do not govern this research workflow. No prior conversation, missing project source, broader theory corpus, or inaccessible attachment is silently reconstructed. “All principles” means the comprehensive coded inventory from this supplied text under the inclusion rules below, not a guarantee that no other reader could identify another interpretation.

2.2 Extraction procedure and inclusion rules

The procedure was to read the page-preserving text in sequence, identify claims concerning knowledge, measurement, causal mechanisms, optimization, learning, or institutional behavior, merge repeated claims, and retain their distinct source locations. A separate AI-assisted extraction pass checked omissions. This improves coverage but is not independent human coding and does not establish

inter-rater reliability. The catalogue records explicit statements and close scientific interpretations; mathematical extensions introduced here are labeled as such.

A principle was included if it provided a potentially generalizable rule, a measurable hypothesis, an operational constraint, a methodological distinction, or a fictional premise that could be mistaken for science. Plot-only material, names without scientific content, and decorative metaphors were excluded. Ethical and philosophical commitments were retained where they materially constrain a proposed experiment or objective. Repetition in dialogue and appendices contributes provenance, not multiple independent instances of evidence.

Code	Claim class	Interpretation in this paper
M	Mathematical / methodological	A definition, derivation, or method whose validity depends on explicit assumptions; not proof of applicability.
E	Empirical connection	A connection to a measured construct or published study; support remains limited to that study's design and population.
H	Hypothesis	A testable proposal whose narrative-specific benefit or mechanism has not been demonstrated.
N	Normative / philosophical	A value, ethical constraint, or epistemic commitment; not a law inferred from an experiment.
F	Fictional premise	A story-world claim with no evidence supplied here for its physical or biological realization.

Table 1: Claim-status vocabulary. Several codes may apply to different parts of one principle.

2.3 Literature selection

Literature was selected to anchor particular mappings: robust optimization, information disclosure, probability scoring, interoception, social influence, learning, and component testing. Primary papers, author-hosted texts, publisher records, and bibliographic records were checked for the cited title and publication identity. The resulting reference list is selective; it is not a reproducible systematic search or an exhaustive assessment of treatment efficacy. A missing full-text retrieval is not represented as a full-text review. The source-to-principle links in Appendix A are the central evidence for what the narrative contains; the external papers support only the limited scientific connections made in the main text.

3 Inference, provenance, and calibrated uncertainty

3.1 Reality, representations, and time

The dialogue on PDF pages 46–47 separates reality from an observer's current belief. This is an epistemic commitment, not an experimentally established metaphysics. Its scientifically useful formulation is that a proposition about a specified system, time, and measurement procedure has a truth condition distinct from the observer's confidence. Systems themselves change. A statement about a heart rate at time t need not remain true at $t+1$. The narrative's language about unchanging truth should therefore not be misread as physical stationarity.

Let H denote a hypothesis and D observations. Bayesian updating, when a prior and likelihood

are defensible, gives

$$p(H \mid D) = \frac{p(D \mid H)p(H)}{\sum_{H'} p(D \mid H')p(H')}. \tag{1}$$

This is a consistency relation within a model. It neither guarantees that the hypothesis set contains a good explanation nor turns a poorly calibrated likelihood into knowledge. In particular, the fact that $p(D \mid H) > 0$ establishes compatibility, not comparative support. Evidence for H_1 relative to H_0 depends on $p(D \mid H_1)/p(D \mid H_0)$ and the prior odds. The foldspace scene explicitly recognizes this distinction (source PDF, pp. 26–27).

3.2 Evidence can be selected or manufactured

The courier scene concentrates suggestive affiliations around one event (source PDF, pp. 6–12). A scientifically defensible reading considers alternatives: independent causes, a common cause, deliberate staging, or selective observation. The appearance of several clues does not license multiplying likelihood ratios as if those clues were independent.

One extension is to introduce a source state A, such as ordinary reporting or deliberate manipulation:

$$p(D \mid H) = \sum_a p(D \mid H, A = a)\, p(A = a \mid H). \tag{2}$$

No numerical manipulation probability is provided by the story. The equation merely exposes an assumption otherwise hidden inside the likelihood. An absence is informative only relative to a model of what would ordinarily be observed or reported. Silence, omission, affiliation, or an unexplained invitation is not itself proof of fear, deception, or coordination.

For an auditable claim, record a timestamp, source identifier, observation procedure, raw observation, uncertainty, interpretation, alternatives, and a proposed disconfirming observation. Hashes can reveal subsequent file changes; they do not establish authenticity, correct measurement, or the truth of the contents. Keeping raw observation distinct from interpretation also helps prevent hindsight from rewriting what was predicted (source PDF, pp. 45,76).

3.3 Emotion and intuition as inputs

The source repeatedly treats feeling as information without equating it with an external fact (source PDF, pp. 13,38,71–74). A report of fear can be evidence about the person's experience. It does not by itself establish an external threat. Intuition can generate a candidate hypothesis; its predictive validity must be measured against outcomes and alternative explanations. The same distinction applies to posture, a change in voice, or a facial movement. These are observations to investigate with consent, not reliable labels for another person's motives.

Identity investment creates another failure mode: an analyst may defend an explanation because being right has become part of self-concept (source PDF, pp. 38–39). Experimental work on biased assimilation provides a relevant connection [10]; it does not diagnose the fictional characters or imply that every disagreement is irrational. A useful procedure is to state, before observing the next result, what evidence would change a conclusion and by how much.

3.4 Proper scoring and confidence

For binary outcomes $y_i \in \{0, 1\}$ and forecasts $p_i \in [0, 1]$, use the binary Brier convention

$$B = \frac{1}{n} \sum_{i=1}^{n} (p_i - y_i)^2. \tag{3}$$

This convention differs by a factor of two from a sum over both complementary categories. The underlying principle is proper scoring: honest probabilities minimize expected loss under the specified score [3, 4].

Proposition 1 (Expected quadratic forecast loss)**.** *If Y is Bernoulli with true event probability q, then*

$$\mathbb{E}[(p - Y)^2] = (p - q)^2 + q(1 - q). \tag{4}$$

The unique minimum over $p \in [0, 1]$ is attained at $p = q$.

Proof. Expand $q(p - 1)^2 + (1 - q)p^2$ and complete the square. The residual term is independent of p. □

A low average Brier score alone is not a complete calibration analysis: it combines several aspects of forecast quality and depends on event difficulty. Report reliability curves with uncertainty, resolution, a base-rate benchmark, and performance on held-out problems. Repeated trials from the same participant require clustered uncertainty estimates. Confidence and correctness should be separately recorded rather than inferred from articulate explanations.

3.5 Independent judgment and communication

Separate examinations in the story address whether two skilled collaborators retain individual competence (source PDF, pp. 33–35). A common scientific implementation obtains private initial estimates, allows structured discussion, then measures both individual and team performance. Social influence can reduce diversity without improving accuracy in some estimation settings [11]; group collaboration is not automatically beneficial or harmful.

For n equal-variance estimators with common pairwise error correlation ρ, the mean error has variance

$$\mathrm{Var}(\bar{e}) = \frac{\sigma^2}{n}\{1 + (n - 1)\rho\}, \qquad -\frac{1}{n - 1} \le \rho \le 1. \tag{5}$$

This calculation explains why thirty agreeing opinions need not supply thirty independent observations. It assumes equal variances and correlations and says nothing by itself about group bias. Wrist signals in the story provide a separate communication example: a low-bandwidth code can transmit decisions, but effectiveness depends on an agreed codebook, channel error, and context. Shannon's communication theory concerns transmission and uncertainty, not the truth or moral value of a message [5].

4 BLACK VECTOR as two ordinary mathematical problems

4.1 Robust trajectory admissibility

The first research prompt, named the Cenva Stability Problem, asks for a distinction between a locally efficient path and one that remains admissible when geometry changes (source PDF,

pp. 22–24,80). It supplies no dynamical equations, uncertainty distribution, or physical mechanism. The following formulation is therefore an extension developed for this paper, informed by robust optimization [2].

Let $x : [0, T] \to \mathbb{R}^d$ be a candidate path, θ_0 nominal environmental parameters, and $g_j(x(t), t, \theta) \geq 0$, $j = 1, \ldots, m$, the constraints. Endpoint and dynamical requirements, if any, must be imposed separately. Let

$$\mathcal{U}_\epsilon = \{\theta : \|\theta - \theta_0\| \leq \epsilon\}, \qquad m_j(x) = \inf_{t \in [0,T]} g_j(x(t), t, \theta_0). \tag{6}$$

Robust admissibility requires each constraint at every time and for every allowed disturbance, not just on a nominal grid.

Proposition 2 (A sufficient margin certificate)**.** *Suppose, uniformly over the candidate path, time interval, and uncertainty set,*

$$|g_j(x(t), t, \theta) - g_j(x(t), t, \theta_0)| \leq L_j \|\theta - \theta_0\|. \tag{7}$$

If $m_j(x) \geq L_j \epsilon$ for every j, then x satisfies all constraints for every $\theta \in \mathcal{U}_\epsilon$. Strict inequalities yield a strictly positive certified residual margin.

Proof. For any t and allowed θ, $g_j(x(t), t, \theta) \geq g_j(x(t), t, \theta_0) - L_j \epsilon \geq m_j(x) - L_j \epsilon \geq 0$. □

If the actual trajectory also deviates by at most η in a specified state norm, and the constraint is Lipschitz in state with constant K_j, the sufficient condition becomes $m_j(x) \geq L_j \epsilon + K_j \eta$. These are conservative certificates, not necessary conditions. The constants must be valid across the whole uncertainty region. A sampled minimum alone is not a continuous-time guarantee unless an interpolation or derivative bound controls between-sample behavior. A disturbance outside the modeled set invalidates the guarantee's applicability.

With path cost $C(x)$, a robust decision solves

$$\min_{x \in \mathcal{X}} C(x) \quad \text{subject to} \quad \inf_{t, \theta \in \mathcal{U}_\epsilon} g_j(x(t), t, \theta) \geq 0 \quad \forall j. \tag{8}$$

Here $\mathcal{X}$ includes the endpoints and dynamics. If the feasible set is empty, abstention, delay, or redesign is a legitimate outcome. Increasing ϵ can shrink this set and raise the optimal cost; it does not create safety for free. When uncertainty is probabilistic, chance constraints are a different formulation and require distributional assumptions. This certificate does not establish physical foldspace, quantum branch control, or consciousness-mediated navigation.

4.2 Stochastic allocation and nonanticipative decisions

The second prompt, named the Junction Allocation Problem, concerns finite transport capacity, uncertain loading, priority classes, and missed connections (source PDF, pp. 24,80). For a network $G = (V, E)$, let jobs i require service and capacity, let ω encode uncertain arrivals and loading times, and let π be a policy. An illustrative objective is

$$\min_{\pi \in \Pi} \mathbb{E}_\omega \left[\sum_i w_i D_i(\pi, \omega) + \sum_i \kappa_i M_i(\pi, \omega) \right], \tag{9}$$

where D_i is delay in time units, M_i is a missed-connection indicator, w_i converts delay into loss units, and κ_i is a loss per missed connection. Combining these terms without units or declared weights would make the objective ambiguous.

Capacity constraints take the form $\sum_i v_i z_{iet} \le C_{et}$ for occupancy variables z_{iet} and job sizes v_i. Flow conservation, precedence, service durations, and priority requirements must also be specified. The policy is nonanticipative: two scenarios with identical observations up to time t must receive identical decisions up to t. Optimizing each scenario with knowledge of its future is a lower-bound benchmark, not an implementable policy. The simple enumeration in Section 7 evaluates static orders in a single-server special case. It is not a solver for a general transport network.

Priority weights are normative design choices. Minimizing a weighted sum can disadvantage low-weight clients. Report unweighted delay, tail delay, missed connections, and class-specific outcomes alongside the objective. Local delay minimization may be globally inefficient when a missed connection propagates downstream. Likewise, institutional efficiency does not establish equitable allocation.

4.3 Privacy is a separate claim

A route-hiding interface can still leak route information through prices, departure notices, timing, or allocation decisions. The scientific formulation must name the secret, observer, auxiliary knowledge, transcript, and permitted leakage. Access control and confidentiality promises are useful operational constraints but are not mathematical proofs of privacy.

For a carefully chosen database adjacency relation, a randomized release $\mathcal{M}$ is $\varepsilon_{\mathrm{DP}}$-differentially private when, for every adjacent D, D' and measurable output set S,

$$\Pr[\mathcal{M}(D) \in S] \le e^{\varepsilon_{\mathrm{DP}}} \Pr[\mathcal{M}(D') \in S]. \tag{10}$$

A scalar query with global sensitivity Δ_1 can use Laplace noise of scale $\Delta_1/\varepsilon_{\mathrm{DP}}$ under the standard construction [6]. This is an optional extension, not a property of the fictional compact. Record-level privacy is not automatically route-topology secrecy. Repeated releases require composition accounting, and noisy internal constraints can violate capacity unless feasibility is separately enforced. This paper implements no privacy-preserving allocation mechanism and claims no leakage guarantee.

5 Embodied calibration and the proposed updating loop

5.1 Measurement before interpretation

The watch sequence proposes a particularly clear methodological rule: estimate a bodily variable before consulting a measurement (source PDF, pp. 64–69). Its value is that it makes disagreement observable. It does not establish that internal sensing outperforms instruments. A wearable has sampling, artifact, and algorithmic error; a subjective estimate has perceptual, memory, expectation, and reporting error. Neither should silently define the other as correct.

Interoceptive accuracy, self-reported sensibility, and metacognitive awareness are distinguishable constructs in the relevant literature [7]. Pulse estimation, respiration estimation, fatigue ratings, muscular tension, and recovery scores also require different measurement models. A proprietary "coherence" score has no usable scientific meaning here until its algorithm, units, validation, and intended interpretation are specified. Missing watch data during an exercise remain missing; recollection is not a replacement physiological recording.

For participant i and trial t, record an estimate $\hat{y}_{it}$, confidence, and the exact time window before

revealing a synchronized reference value y_{it}^{ref}. Then calculate

$$e_{it} = \hat{y}_{it} - y_{it}^{\mathrm{ref}}, \tag{11}$$

$$\mathrm{MAE}_i = \frac{1}{n_i}\sum_t |e_{it}|, \qquad \mathrm{Bias}_i = \frac{1}{n_i}\sum_t e_{it}. \tag{12}$$

An uncertainty interval I_{it} should additionally be assessed for coverage and width. Always reporting a very wide interval is not useful calibration. Error is relative to the reference procedure, whose own uncertainty and invalid-trial criteria must be reported. Do not pool heart-rate errors in beats per minute with respiration errors in breaths per minute without a justified normalization.

An estimate can be accurate because the person knows a typical resting heart rate or infers elapsed time. Heartbeat counting therefore cannot alone identify interoceptive perception; experimental evidence demonstrates substantial non-interoceptive contributions [8]. A stronger battery combines multiple tasks, randomized windows, recorded strategies, baseline-knowledge controls, and a prespecified reference modality. Attending to respiration may also change it, so the estimation and reference windows must coincide.

5.2 Calibration, autonomy, and sensor use

The narrative rejects both replacing a device with unexplained teacher authority and refusing useful technology to maintain an identity (source PDF, pp. 68–69). A real protocol needs explicit criteria: task-specific error tolerances, uncertainty coverage, repeated independent trials, transfer to a new setting, and a plan for detecting drift. Tolerances should follow the intended use and measurement precision, not be invented from the story. Human estimates must not replace monitoring required for care or safety.

Feedback can be compared with delayed feedback or a matched educational control. Removing a display tests performance without visible feedback; it does not necessarily require removing the sensor. Keeping the reference recording while hiding the display avoids creating an unnecessary data gap. Calibration training is a hypothesis about learning, not a consequence of voluntary device surrender.

5.3 Embodied updating as a decomposable intervention

The source combines attention to sensation, an EFT-like tapping sequence, breathing, a verbal revision cue, and reassessment (source PDF, pp. 71–74). The most defensible scientific translation is a multicomponent experimental package, provisionally named *embodied updating*. The sequence is: record the current experience and belief; apply the assigned attention/sensory routine; reassess; identify any new evidence; state whether the belief, affect, or intended action changed. The package is not presented here as a validated therapy.

The word "updating" can describe at least three different events: a change in reported affect, a change in a probabilistic belief about an external proposition, or a change in intended behavior. These outcomes must not be conflated. Feeling calmer does not automatically make a prediction more accurate, and feeling more anxious does not automatically make an exercise unsuccessful. A legitimate result may be greater awareness of fatigue with no change in an external belief.

Breathing research provides a relevant but bounded connection: one randomized study compared structured breathing practices with mindfulness meditation and measured mood and physiological outcomes [9]. It did not test this narrative's complete routine, factual belief accuracy, or meridian

mechanisms. Component studies of EFT likewise do not settle which aspect of a new package would be active [17, 18]. Those studies differ in populations, controls, and tasks; they cannot be pooled informally into proof that the present sequence works. Sensory anchoring, expectancy, rhythmic attention, exposure, task interruption, social support, and the evidence prompt are competing explanations.

No claim is made that the listed tapping points possess special energetic properties. To test location specificity requires a matched alternative-location comparison holding touch, rhythm, expectancy, and instruction as constant as practicable. To test breath pacing requires a matched comparator and a defined comfortable protocol. To test cognitive framing requires a neutral verbal control. The factorial design in Section 8 targets these separable questions.

5.4 Synchrony and interpersonal inference

The paired watch response during fictional travel is an example of underdetermination (source PDF, pp. 26–27). Shared stimuli, common motion artifacts, synchronized instructions, social interaction, chance, and selective inspection can all produce apparent synchrony. A future ordinary physiological study would need synchronized clocks, raw signal quality checks, predefined windows, baseline and shuffled-pair controls, and models accounting for autocorrelation. Selecting the largest cross-correlation after trying many lags inflates apparent evidence.

The same caution applies to behavioral cues. A gaze shift, reduced blinking, or muscle tension is not an individually validated lie detector. The deception-cue literature finds many weak or absent associations [16]. This does not imply that all nonverbal information is useless; it means that a scientific claim needs predictive performance and error rates in its intended setting. Consent to observe, collect, infer, or share personal data remains distinct from the ability to notice a cue.

6 Cooperative mastery and institutional systems

6.1 A multidimensional competence model

The academy's ten critique domains are analytical, mathematical, political, humanistic, ethical, integrative, self-critical, somatic, martial, and biological (source PDF, p. 50). The fictional scale describes demonstrated program-level mastery rather than perfection. A scientific implementation first defines observable competencies, task samples, assessors, measurement error, and a defensible threshold for each domain. Equal-looking numbers across domains do not establish equal intervals or comparable difficulty.

Let a_{ik} denote learner i's competence on domain k, with criterion τ_k. Individual certification is

$$C_i = \prod_{k=1}^{K} \mathbf{1}\{a_{ik} \geq \tau_k\}. \tag{13}$$

In practice a_{ik} is latent and assessed imperfectly, so certification needs a measurement model, uncertainty, and repeat or independent evaluation near thresholds. The fictional all-or-none rule corresponds to

$$G = \prod_{i=1}^{N} C_i. \tag{14}$$

Equation (14) specifies an institutional decision rule, not a law of learning. A program may alternatively use individual certification plus a separate collective milestone. That preserves the cooperative research question while avoiding the automatic withholding of an earned credential.

6.2 Incentives, bottlenecks, and possible harms

A shared terminal condition can make helping a peer instrumentally valuable. It can also create pressure to conceal problems, lower standards, exclude a struggling learner, or scapegoat the person delaying the group. Cooperation is not implied by the objective alone. Costs of helping, unequal teaching ability, rival commitments, attrition, and opportunities to manipulate assessment all matter.

If individuals independently attain certification with identical probability p, then $\Pr(G = 1) = p^N$. The calculation is intentionally stylized: peer interactions violate independence, and actual learners differ. Nevertheless it demonstrates how a stringent aggregate endpoint can be fragile even when individual outcomes are good. A more general expression is $\Pr(C_1 = \cdots = C_N = 1)$; marginal probabilities alone do not determine it when outcomes are dependent.

A complementary support-allocation objective is

$$\max_{u \in \mathcal{U}} \min_{i,k} \frac{a_{ik} + \Delta_{ik}(u) - \tau_k}{s_k}, \qquad s_k > 0, \tag{15}$$

where u allocates teaching resources, Δ_{ik} is an estimated improvement, and s_k supplies a defensible domain scale. This max–min formulation represents concern for the largest remaining deficit. It does not prove that a predicted learning gain is attainable, that interpersonal differences are deficits, or that resource allocation is fair under every value system.

Research on collective intelligence and psychological safety motivates measuring group processes and the willingness to acknowledge errors [12, 13]. These findings do not establish the efficacy of a thirty-person, all-or-none certification rule. A responsible trial measures independent competence, retention, support quality, distress, exclusion, time burden, and equity. It allows withdrawal and reasonable accommodation without assigning blame to peers.

6.3 Adaptive progression and transfer

The instructional loop has four named outcomes: repeat, advance, integrate, or certify (source PDF, pp. 52–53,79). Rest can be an intentional action as well. A policy $u_t = \pi(s_t)$ can choose among these options from a state s_t containing task performance, uncertainty, prior practice, fatigue, and the cost of further assessment. Selection should be based on predeclared criteria and be reviewable; the instructor's approval is not a substitute for valid measurement.

Retrieval-practice research offers a connection between demonstration and durable retention [14]. Sleep-dependent improvement in a studied motor task supports including recovery in some training designs [15], but does not establish a universal rest prescription. Similarly, testing under time pressure may reveal transfer limits, but deliberately exhausting students is neither necessary nor justified merely because it makes an exercise difficult. Unfamiliar tasks, separate assessment of partners, and delayed retention can assess generalization with less confounding.

Broad exposure does not grant specialist qualification. The narrative makes that boundary explicit (source PDF, pp. 50–51). A curriculum integrating biology, mathematics, and ethics must still state what its graduates can and cannot do. Novelty in a research degree likewise requires an identifiable contribution, transparent methods, and critical scrutiny; it cannot be inferred from prestige or proficiency alone.

6.4 Multilayer systems and leading indicators

The story treats its central commodity as a dependency across transport, institutions, and social life (source PDF, p. 29). The transferable principle is to specify system boundaries and interdependencies. One possible exploratory model is

$$z_{t+1} = Az_t + Bu_t + \eta_t, \qquad y_t = Cz_t + \nu_t, \tag{16}$$

where z_t is a latent system state, y_t observed transport, health, security, or economic indicators, and u_t actions. This linear form is an illustrative modeling choice, not a fitted description of any actual society. Apparent common movement can reflect common shocks, shared reporting, feedback, or independent processes. An inferred latent factor is not automatically a cause.

The transport-demand example suggests a leading-indicator hypothesis (source PDF, p. 44). Test prediction at a fixed horizon on future data, against seasonal and simple baseline models, with leakage controls and calibration checks. Retrospectively selecting a signal after a crisis is not prospective prediction. The narrative also emphasizes asymmetric error costs: discussing contingencies has a cost, while missing a severe disruption may have a larger cost. Any decision threshold must declare both, including false-alarm and opportunity costs.

Finally, shared dependence can create incentives for cooperation among rivals (source PDF, pp. 41–42,60–61). A formal game requires players, information, available actions, payoffs, and enforcement. Common risk alone need not solve coordination. Institutional access, a famous sponsor, and usefulness remain different variables from protection or aligned interests.

7 Reproducible illustrative results

All quantities in this section are synthetic or analytically specified. They are not observations from the story, estimates from participants, or effects of an intervention. The accompanying Python program uses exact rational arithmetic for the scoring identity and enumerates every order and scenario in the scheduling example. Its JSON output and generated table are included in the project.

7.1 A fragile efficient candidate and a robust alternative

Consider two abstract candidate corridors with normalized nominal costs 1.00 and 1.25, clearances $c_A = 0.12$ and $c_B = 0.35$, and constraints $g_r = c_r - \delta$ for $|\delta| \le \epsilon$. The scalar disturbance has sensitivity $L = 1$. At $\epsilon = 0.20$, their worst-case residuals are -0.08 and 0.15. Thus A is nominally feasible and cheaper but fails under the permitted disturbance $\delta = 0.20$; B remains feasible. Because the constraint is exactly affine, the worst-case residual here is exact. For general nonlinear problems a failed sufficient certificate does not itself prove infeasibility.

The cost and clearance values are assigned to make the tradeoff inspectable. They are not path lengths inferred from a physical geometry. No assertion is made about navigation engines, spacetime metrics, or real transport safety. Figure 1 shows where the margin vanishes as the disturbance bound increases.

7.2 Confidence can increase expected loss

With true event probability $q = 0.70$, forecasts $p = 0.50$, 0.70, and 0.95 have expected Brier scores 0.2500, 0.2100, and 0.2725, respectively. Moving from a calibrated forecast to an overconfident one

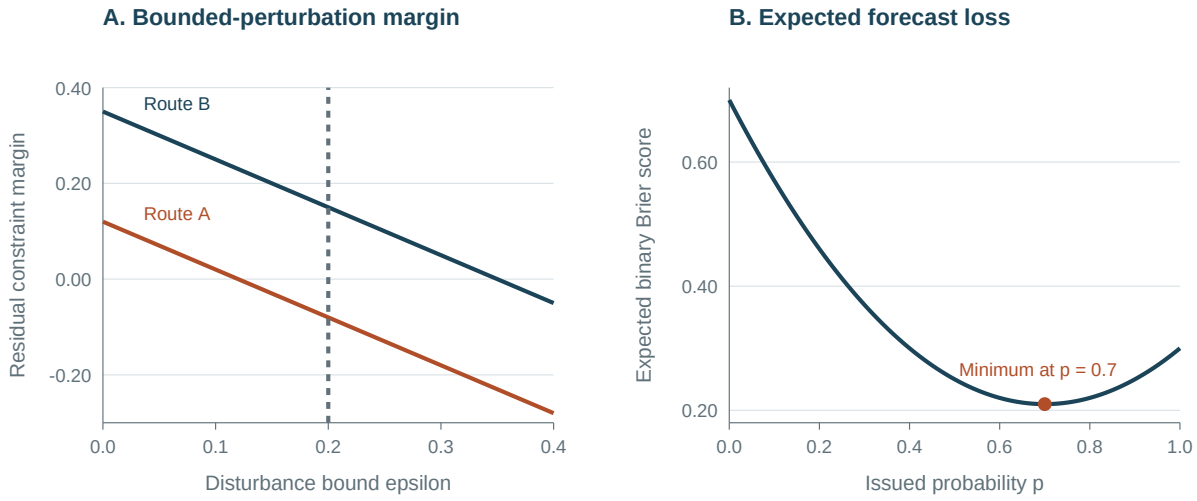


Figure 1: Two deterministic mathematical illustrations. (A) Exact residual margins $c_r - \epsilon$ for abstract corridors; the dashed line marks $\epsilon = 0.20$. (B) Expected binary Brier score for a Bernoulli event with $q = 0.70$. The plotted curves are calculations, not fitted data.

increases expected loss despite sounding more decisive. These are expectations under a known toy distribution, not a study showing that a particular training method improves confidence or accuracy.

7.3 Allocation under uncertain loading

Three jobs A, B, and C share one nonpreemptive server and are available at time zero. Loading times are independently $S_A \in \{1, 5\}$ and $S_C \in \{2, 4\}$, each with equal probability; $S_B = 2$. Connection deadlines are $(4, 3, 7)$, delay weights $(1, 2, 1)$, and miss penalties $(10, 8, 6)$. For completion time F_i, define tardiness $D_i = \max(0, F_i - d_i)$ and a miss when $F_i > d_i$. Finishing exactly at the deadline is not a miss. The server follows a static permutation without idling and without knowing the future loading realizations.

Order	Expected loss	Expected tardiness	Expected misses
BAC	11.00	3.00	1.00
BCA	14.00	4.00	1.00
ABC	18.00	4.00	1.50
ACB	25.50	6.00	1.75
CBA	26.00	6.00	2.00
CAB	27.75	7.25	1.75

Table 2: Exact enumeration for the four equally likely synthetic loading scenarios. Tardiness is summed across jobs in time units. The loss includes declared priority weights and missed-connection penalties.

The best of the six enumerated static orders is BAC with expected loss 11.00. For BAC the four scenario losses are $0, 0, 21, 23$, whose mean is 11.00. This confirms only optimality within this finite policy class and these four equiprobable scenarios. An adaptive network policy has a different

decision space. Changing priorities, deadlines, correlations, or available capacity can change the ranking. No confidential real routes were used, and this calculation supplies no privacy guarantee.

7.4 The all-or-none bottleneck

For thirty independent learners with identical success probability, p^{30} is approximately 0.0424 for $p = 0.90$, 0.2146 for $p = 0.95$, and 0.7397 for $p = 0.99$. These values demonstrate sensitivity of a collective endpoint to individual probabilities. They do not estimate any real graduation rate. Peer learning, shared instruction, and group stress can introduce dependence, so both benefit and harm must be evaluated rather than inferred from the formula.

8 Prospective research protocols

The following are protocol proposals, not registered or completed studies. No sample size, approval, recruitment, clinical benefit, or successful intervention is claimed. Before data collection, freeze hypotheses, randomization, exclusion rules, primary outcomes, analysis code, and a power calculation based on a defensible minimally relevant effect. Simulation should assess the proposed estimator under missingness, realistic clustering, and uncertainty in effect size. A feasibility pilot should inform procedures without being relabeled as a confirmatory trial.

8.1 Study A: robustness and scheduling benchmarks

Question. Does a robust policy reduce constraint violations under disturbances represented in its uncertainty set, and at what cost? Compare a nominal optimizer, a robust optimizer, and a simple conservative baseline on released synthetic instances. Vary perturbation magnitude, model misspecification, network congestion, and available information. Freeze scenario generators and test sets separately from algorithm tuning.

Outcomes and falsifiers. Report violation rates with uncertainty, worst observed violation, nominal cost, compute time, missed connections, and unweighted and class-specific delays. An in-set violation despite a valid certificate would expose an implementation error, invalid bound, or violated assumption. Out-of-set failures characterize robustness limits. Report infeasibility explicitly rather than silently dropping difficult instances. Any separate privacy claim requires its own adjacency relation, leakage definition, composition analysis, and proof or adversarial evaluation.

8.2 Study B: prediction-first physiological calibration

Design. Randomly assign consenting adults to structured estimate–feedback training or a matched educational control with delayed aggregate feedback. Keep a blinded reference sensor recording in both groups. Predefine posture, estimation windows, rest intervals, display visibility, signal-quality exclusions, and the separate tasks for pulse and respiration. Collect confidence before revealing feedback and record participants' estimation strategies. Include an unfamiliar assessment context and a delayed retention visit.

Primary estimand. The difference between groups in change in held-out heart-rate MAE relative to a specified reference method. Respiration error, signed bias, interval coverage, confidence–accuracy association, and distress are secondary. Use a baseline-adjusted participant-level model or a prespecified hierarchical model; repeated trials are not independent participants. Analyze

all randomized participants according to assignment, describe missingness, and perform stated sensitivity analyses. A practically null or adverse effect on the primary outcome would count against the training hypothesis even if self-reported confidence improved.

Interpretation. Performance relative to one device does not establish perfect awareness of internal physiology. Heartbeat counting is not the sole endpoint. The trial would not justify removing medically necessary monitoring or assuming that skill transfers to untested bodily variables.

8.3 Study C: component testing of embodied updating

Design. An eight-arm, parallel $2 \times 2 \times 2$ factorial study can compare (i) the source-inspired tapping locations versus matched alternative-location touch, (ii) comfortable paced breathing versus a matched period of unpaced breathing, and (iii) an evidence-revision cue versus neutral wording. Session duration, facilitator contact, task instructions, and expected plausibility should be matched as far as possible. Record expectancy and adherence. Participants cannot be fully blinded to action differences; analysts and outcome assessors can be masked to assignment.

Task and primary outcome. Use repeated probabilistic inference tasks with a declared generative model, new evidence, and later binary outcomes. Obtain forecasts before and after evidence, separating any bodily-state change from the factual revision. The primary outcome is mean post-evidence Brier score on held-out tasks, adjusted for baseline performance. Prespecify the main contrast for each factor and adjust for the three confirmatory comparisons; interactions and affective outcomes can be designated secondary unless the study is powered for them. A hierarchical model should account for participant and task dependence.

Mechanistic limits. This design tests tapping-location specificity, breath-pacing contribution, and cue contribution within a matched procedure. It does not isolate every ingredient, establish a meridian mechanism, or directly compare the whole package with no intervention. A separate no-touch control would be needed to estimate the contribution of rhythmic touch itself. Better mood without better inference would support an affective outcome only. More revision when evidence is uninformative could be a harmful increase in suggestibility. Report unchanged and worsening outcomes as well as improvements.

8.4 Study D: cooperative learning without coercive certification

Design. Randomize multiple intact learning groups to structured peer support with a collective milestone or to an equally resourced individual-progression program. Preserve individual certification and withdrawal in both arms. This intentionally tests a less coercive implementation of the source's cooperative idea; it is not a literal test of withholding every learner's credential until all pass.

Outcomes. The primary outcome is independently assessed individual mastery on unfamiliar tasks at a fixed follow-up. Secondary outcomes include delayed retention, dispersion of learning gains, time to mastery, helping behavior, assessment integrity, distress, exclusion, and perceived pressure. Assessors should be blind to group assignment. The group is the randomization unit; power and uncertainty must reflect the number of groups and intracluster correlation, not merely the number of learners. A single thirty-person cohort cannot identify the program's causal effect.

8.5 Consent, data governance, and stopping rules

Any human study requires prospective review by the responsible ethics body, individual informed consent, a clear withdrawal procedure, and avoidance of academic or interpersonal penalties for declining. Physiological recordings and personal inferences are sensitive data: collect the minimum necessary, separate identities from analysis records, define retention and access, and publish only appropriately governed outputs. The source's paired consent scene does not substitute for these procedures.

Breathing and attention tasks should permit ordinary comfortable breathing, immediate cessation for discomfort, and a prespecified response to adverse events. The proposed study need not use breath holds, hyperventilation, forced disclosure, sleep deprivation, or physical threat. Those would introduce additional interventions and risks unrelated to the central hypotheses. A stopping plan should specify who reviews adverse events and when recruitment or a procedure is suspended. These are research-design requirements, not claims that the narrative's practice is safe or unsafe in every setting.

9 Discussion and limitations

9.1 What the synthesis contributes

The common structure across the source is a separation between a state of the world, an observation, an internal representation, a chosen action, and feedback. Robust optimization asks whether a decision remains admissible when conditions differ from expectation. Calibration asks whether a person's estimate agrees with an independently recorded reference. Cooperative education asks whether an incentive structure improves learning without compromising autonomy or assessment. These questions share a need to expose assumptions, but they do not become the same scientific problem.

The novel source-specific contribution is the explicit connection among these themes, the page-indexed extraction, and the proposed evaluation program. The robustness inequality, proper scoring identity, information-theoretic concepts, and probability calculations are established mathematical ideas or elementary consequences. Naming them after story elements does not make them new discoveries. The scheduling result is new only as the output of this particular toy instance.

9.2 What is not established

No human outcomes support the proposed embodied-updating routine in this manuscript. No evidence establishes that microexpressions detect lies, that a global coherence score measures epistemic quality, that advanced interoception removes instrument error, or that a shared graduation rule improves education. These are either inadequately specified constructs or hypotheses requiring separate tests.

The fictional engineered lineage and foldspace experiences provide no evidence for genetic inheritance of computational architectures, extraordinary cognitive powers, consciousness-mediated selection of physical outcomes, or a new spacetime theory. The source itself treats branch selection as a metaphor and toy model. It contains no equations that identify it with a broader theory of everything, MQGT-SCF, or any independently supplied cosmological framework. Such connections would require separate sources, explicit mathematical maps, and evidence; they cannot be inferred

from thematic similarity.

A scientific theory of spacetime navigation would at minimum require a specified physical model, consistency with the relevant dynamics and constraints, quantitative observables, and comparison with existing evidence. None of those requirements is supplied by a fictional physiological trace. Likewise, a biological claim needs a defined mechanism and measured phenotype; an evocative origin story supplies neither.

9.3 Limits of extraction and evidence

The catalogue is comprehensive under its declared coding rules, but its boundaries reflect analytical judgment. Some rows separate closely related ideas to preserve operational distinctions; others combine repeated dialogue. A second AI-assisted pass is not independent replication. The source is a retrospective literary reconstruction, which prevents treating scene order, character agreement, or reported sensation as raw records. The external literature is selected rather than systematic, and many mappings remain analogies.

The numerical examples are intentionally too small to support claims about real networks or people. Their advantage is inspectability: every assumption and scenario is visible, and all outputs can be regenerated. Passing code checks, resolving citations, or producing a clean PDF establishes artifact integrity, not empirical truth. Formal correctness is conditional on assumptions; scientific applicability remains a separate question.

10 Conclusion

The scientific content recoverable from *The Quiet Calculus* is strongest as a disciplined research agenda: preserve observations, model uncertainty and evidence provenance, separate feasibility from efficiency, estimate before revealing feedback, test intervention components, and evaluate cooperative incentives with individual accountability. The accompanying catalogue and reproducible examples make these ideas concrete while preserving their evidential status. The next scientific step is prospective testing of narrowly defined claims, not expansion of the fictional premises into asserted facts.

Declarations

Manuscript status. Local conceptual and methods manuscript, version 1.0, prepared October 25, 2026. It has not been submitted, published, externally peer reviewed, or clinically validated. The proposed studies have not been preregistered or performed.

Authorship and AI assistance. Prepared for Christopher Michael Baird using Zora as the working name of an AI research assistant. AI assistance contributed extraction, literature identification, synthesis, drafting, code, and formatting. Additional AI-assisted review checked source coverage and references. No claim is made that Grok, Claude, Gemini, or an independent human reviewer participated. The human author must review and accept responsibility for any eventual submission.

Data and code availability. Local source files, the 92-item catalogue in machine-readable form, deterministic scripts, computed outputs, reference records, and artifact-verification files accompany this manuscript. The original narrative remains at its supplied local location and is identified by its SHA-256 digest; it is not required to compile the paper. No participant dataset exists.

Funding and competing interests. No external funding or competing-interest information was supplied for this preparation. These statements require author confirmation for a journal submission; absence of supplied information is not a declaration of absence.

Source attribution. The source identifies itself as a noncommercial fan-created campaign artifact and attributes the established Dune setting to its rights holders. This paper analyzes and paraphrases its conceptual content, does not reproduce its artwork, and does not assert affiliation with the franchise or its publishers. The paper does not assign a new license to the source material.

A Complete source-grounded principle catalogue

This catalogue contains 92 distinct coded items, including methodological principles, hypotheses, ethical commitments, and fictional boundaries. It is not a list of 92 established scientific laws. Rows marked H require testing; rows marked F do not describe observed reality. M, E, and N have the meanings in Table 1. All locators are physical PDF pages. Close interpretations and critical extensions are identified in their wording.

ID	Principle and scientific qualification	Pages; class
P01	**Observe before intervening.** Preserve the evidential state and log interventions; premature action can change the observation target.	6–7,19; M
P02	**Model the evidence-generating process.** Conspicuous clues can be selected or manufactured. Their number is not their independence.	6–7,11–12; M
P03	**Maintain competing hypotheses.** Include ordinary, common-cause, and adversarial alternatives; compare predictions rather than narrative appeal.	6,12,40–42; M
P04	**Interpret absence conditionally.** Omission is informative only under an explicit model of what would otherwise be observed or reported.	7,11,25; M
P05	**Urgency and ambiguity can influence judgment.** A test should vary framing while holding evidence fixed; the scene supplies no effect estimate.	7,11; H
P06	**Coincidence does not establish connection.** Treat proposed links as provisional until discriminating evidence addresses alternatives.	11–12; M
P07	**Separate heritage, utility, and mechanism.** Historical attribution, subjective usefulness, and causal validity require different evidence.	8,71–73; M
P08	**Evaluate capability externally.** Use unfamiliar tasks and independent assessment; an authority's endorsement alone does not validate a standard.	16–17,39; M/H
P09	**Distinguish honesty from unlimited disclosure.** Respect confidentiality while making limitations and consequential omissions explicit.	33–34,51; N/M
P10	**Distinguish models from targets.** Declare assumptions, approximations, and the conditions under which a model applies.	19,27,37–38,47; M
P11	**Audit input integrity.** Correct computation cannot repair false premises without an error model or additional evidence.	36; M
P12	**Separate fluency, precision, and certainty.** Measure confidence against outcomes; an articulate explanation is not a calibration test.	37–38; M
P13	**Reasoning can defend preferred conclusions.** Biased assimilation offers an empirical connection; do not label all disagreement as motivated reasoning.	38; E/H
P14	**Identity can compete with revision.** Compare neutral and identity-relevant conditions; the narrative provides no measured causal effect.	38,69; H
P15	**Treat emotion as an observation.** A feeling can inform a model of the observer without establishing an external threat or proposition.	13,38,79; M/E
P16	**Record predictions prospectively.** Timestamp forecasts and preserve versions before outcomes; a hash does not authenticate a claim's truth.	45,76; M
P17	**Combine fallibilism with shared truth conditions.** Specify the proposition and time; changing reality is compatible with revisable knowledge.	35,46–47,79; N/M
P18	**Revisability requires source scrutiny.** Being open to change does not require accepting manufactured or unverified evidence.	46–47; M
P19	**Representation depends on perspective.** Measure differences in attention, language, and interpretation without assuming equally accurate models.	47; H/N
P20	**Separate expressed belief from compelled behavior.** Power may alter what is said or done; those changes do not establish factual accuracy.	47; H/N
P21	**Allow justified uncertainty and abstention.** Score appropriate refusal alongside accuracy; unanswered questions need not be analytical failures.	26–27,35,57; M
P22	**Distinguish compatibility from confirmation.** Compare alternative predictive likelihoods; a shared prediction cannot uniquely identify a mechanism.	26–27; M

ID	Principle and scientific qualification (continued)	Pages; class
P23	**Separate feasibility from optimality.** An efficient nominal route can violate constraints; write the objective and constraints separately.	22–24,80; M
P24	**Quantify robust feasibility.** Specify uncertainty sets and the requirement to satisfy constraints for every permitted disturbance.	22–24,80; M
P25	**Use margins with regularity bounds.** A nominal safety margin needs a sensitivity bound before it can certify perturbation tolerance.	22,24,80; M
P26	**Local optimality does not imply robustness.** The margin certificate in this paper is a new formalization of the source's question.	23–24,80; M
P27	**Expose efficiency–safety tradeoffs.** Compare constrained or Pareto formulations; the selected tradeoff depends on stated objectives.	22–24; M/N
P28	**Respect information constraints.** An implementable policy uses only information available at the decision time.	23–24; M
P29	**Optimize stochastic capacity allocation.** Specify arrivals, loading uncertainty, occupancy, priority, and delay rather than assuming a complete network model.	24,80; M
P30	**Include downstream connection costs.** A locally fast allocation may create later delays; compare system-wide outcomes.	24,80; M/H
P31	**Declare priority and welfare weights.** Political priority is a design choice; weighted efficiency need not imply equity.	24,80; M/N
P32	**Define confidentiality precisely.** Withholding raw routes is not a leakage guarantee; specify adversaries and observable outputs.	24,80; M/N
P33	**Use formal structure across specialties.** Proof exposes assumptions but does not remove power, model choice, or empirical uncertainty.	23; M/H
P34	**Govern research provenance and dissemination.** The fictional compact motivates accountable access and release rules; it is not an instruction governing this paper.	24; N/M
P35	**Model dependency hubs across layers.** The transferable idea is interdependence; the listed powers of spice remain fictional.	29; M/H/F
P36	**Declare system boundaries.** Test whether added couplings improve prediction rather than assuming that more complex models are better.	29,45,61; M
P37	**Study collective coordination failures.** Specify objectives, information, and shared dependencies; individually rational choices may conflict.	41–42; M/H
P38	**Test coalition formation under common risk.** Shared vulnerability can alter incentives but need not overcome distrust or enforcement problems.	42,60–61; H/M
P39	**Test common-cause explanations.** Multiple domain signals may share a cause, reporting bias, or feedback; independence is not supplied.	44–45; M/H
P40	**Evaluate operational leading indicators.** Transport demand might predict later events; use held-out time periods and declared prediction horizons.	44; H
P41	**Account for asymmetric error costs.** Declare the costs of preparation, false alarms, missed events, and delay.	44–45; M/N
P42	**Distinguish access from protection.** Contact, status, usefulness, aligned interests, and enforceable obligations are separate variables.	19,61,79; H/N
P43	**Test interdisciplinary integration.** Compare cross-domain transfer with equally resourced instruction; broad exposure is not automatically superior.	37,49–51,61; H/N
P44	**Do not generalize from one selected cohort.** Replication requires a counterfactual and attention to selection, teachers, history, and expectations.	61–62; M
P45	**Specify physiological contributions to cognition.** Measure particular states and outcomes instead of treating bodily knowledge as a unitary power.	18,38–39,64–66; E/H
P46	**Validate wearable measurements.** Separate raw signals from inferred sleep, recovery, and undefined coherence scores.	18,26,64,67–69; M
P47	**Compare subjective and instrument estimates.** Both have error; subjective recollection does not replace a missing objective time series.	64–69; M/H

ID	Principle and scientific qualification (continued)	Pages; class
P48	**Estimate before revealing measurement.** Timestamp the estimate and synchronize the reference window to prevent display leakage.	68; M
P49	**Measure confidence and accuracy separately.** Report absolute error, bias, interval coverage, and discrimination rather than confidence alone.	68; M/E
P50	**Assess interoception by domain.** Pulse, breathing, fatigue, tension, and arousal need distinct reference procedures and validation.	68; M/H
P51	**Test adaptive feedback training.** Measure learning, retention, and transfer against matched feedback controls.	68–69; H/M
P52	**Account for measurement reactivity.** Attention to a bodily variable may change it; preserve timing and task context.	64–65,68,71–73; M/H
P53	**Separate performance from impression management.** Observed posture can reflect being watched; compare functional performance across evaluation contexts.	65; H
P54	**Test one-variable attentional scaffolding.** Compare staged attention with simultaneous monitoring; simplicity is a proposed aid, not a demonstrated effect here.	65; H
P55	**Use individual baselines.** Avoid inferring universal meanings from one person's stillness, blinking, or tension.	65,68; H
P56	**Replace vague authority with criteria.** Specify proficiency and stopping conditions rather than treating teacher approval as measurement.	67–69; N/M
P57	**Distinguish tool use from dependence.** Evaluate appropriate selection and performance; rejection of instruments can itself be an identity commitment.	69; N/M
P58	**Test intuition prospectively.** Record the signal before its interpretation and compare predictive value with baseline alternatives.	71,79; H
P59	**Do not equate bodily cues with lie detection.** Validate sensitivity, specificity, context, and error costs; the story's labels establish none of these.	31,55,64–65; E/H
P60	**Do not infer exotic causes from synchrony.** Compare shared stimuli, artifacts, chance, and analysis selection before positing a mechanism.	26–27; M/F
P61	**Include fatigue, rest, and diminishing returns.** Specify task, dose, and outcome; no universal optimum follows from the narrative.	18,39,52–53,68; E/H
P62	**Separate experience from interpretation.** Record sensation, affect, belief, confidence, and action in separate fields.	71–73; M
P63	**Treat updating as a multicomponent package.** Tapping, breathing, attention, cue, and reassessment require component controls.	71–73; H
P64	**Test sensory anchoring.** Compare matched touch, location, rhythm, and expectancy; special efficacy of the listed points is not established.	72; H
P65	**Separate breathing outcomes.** Tempo, attention, physiology, and clinical benefit are distinct endpoints; the source specifies no validated dose.	72–73; E/H
P66	**Test the verbal revision cue.** Compare evidence-focused language with neutral wording while controlling other components.	72; H
P67	**Do not define success only as calm.** Evaluate appropriate detection and revision separately from distress or mood change.	72–73; M/H
P68	**Separate state change from factual updating.** More trust or comfort is not necessarily more accurate belief; identify the evidence for revision.	72–74; M
P69	**Specify a testable feedback loop.** Declare timing, entry criteria, observations, continuation rules, and stopping rules.	73; M/H
P70	**Design software to support awareness.** Test usability, autonomy, and task outcomes; a prompt should not prescribe what the user must feel.	73; H/N
P71	**Treat embodied updating as a protocol candidate.** The source supplies a synthesis and fictional experience, not a validated treatment or effect size.	71–74; H
P72	**Separate knowledge from competence.** Reading, vocabulary, and placement do not establish independent performance or transfer.	12,16,39,54–55,79; M/H

ID	Principle and scientific qualification (continued)	Pages; class
P73	**Distinguish collaboration from dependency.** Assess private capability and the additional benefit or cost of group reasoning.	34–35,55; M/H
P74	**Test performance beyond ideal conditions.** Use ethical, predefined variation in task context; difficulty or suffering is not educational validation.	39,45; H
P75	**Define multidimensional mastery.** Give each domain observable criteria, uncertainty, reliability, and a justified threshold.	49–50; M/N
P76	**Use adaptive instructional decisions.** Repeat, advance, integrate, and certify form a policy to evaluate against alternatives.	52–53,79; M/H
P77	**Treat rest as a possible training action.** Distinguish a justified consolidation interval from an unexplained pause.	52–53; E/H
P78	**Treat placement as uncertain and revisable.** Scores are estimates, not fixed identities or automatically comparable interval scales.	54–55; M/H
P79	**Consider person–environment interactions.** Evaluate teaching, context, fear, physiology, and knowledge before locating every obstacle in the learner.	56; H/M
P80	**Test shared success incentives.** The terminal rule may reward helping; actual cooperation depends on costs and enforcement.	55–56,79; M/H/N
P81	**Evaluate bottlenecks and coercion.** This critical implication extends the source: monitor scapegoating, concealment, exclusion, and unfair delay.	55–56,79; H/N
P82	**Target peer support to individual needs.** Compare structured tutoring with unstructured interaction and assess both partners' outcomes.	56; H
P83	**Make certification accountable.** Use explicit criteria, independent assessment, assessor agreement, and a review or appeal path.	52–53,68; N/M
P84	**Distinguish exposure from qualification.** Foundational instruction does not confer specialist membership, credentials, or unrestricted competence.	50–51; N/M
P85	**Distinguish novelty from repetition.** A contribution requires identifiable new knowledge or method, scrutiny, and reproducibility.	49; N/M
P86	**Obtain individual voluntary consent.** Agreement is each participant's decision; authority or a partner's request is not a substitute.	67–68; N
P87	**Observation does not grant entitlement.** Permission to collect, interpret, share, and act on personal data are distinct questions.	65–66; N
P88	**Record knowledge boundaries about people.** Keep observed facts separate from stereotypes, guesses, and unverified personal narratives.	57–58; N/M
P89	**Separate capability from ethical objectives.** Analytical efficiency does not guarantee prosocial conduct or moral judgment.	37; N/H
P90	**Treat engineered lineage as fiction.** No genotype, developmental mechanism, or evidence supports machine inheritance or superior cognition here.	9–10; F
P91	**Keep branch selection at the toy-model level.** Robust decisions do not establish spacetime folding, quantum control, or mental selection of reality.	21–27,50,80; F/M
P92	**Keep fictional capabilities and institutions illustrative.** The setting motivates questions; it supplies no observations of extraordinary human powers or physics.	4,21–27,36–37,49–51; F

B Source coverage and reproducibility

B.1 Coverage by source unit

Source unit	PDF pages	Principal extracted content
Cover and front matter	1–5	Fictional status, authorship, structure.
Prologue: The Messenger	6–7	Evidence preservation, staging, urgency.
1. The Pattern Beneath the Pattern	8–10	Provenance, attention, fictional lineage.
2. The Letter for Zora Vey	11–13	Provisional connections, emotion as data.
3. The Marriage Before Dawn	14–15	Mutual correction and autonomy; otherwise narrative context.
4. The Interview	16–17	External standards and mutual evaluation.
5. Departure	18–20	Instruments, models, disclosure, system context.
6. Mathematics Is a Brotherhood	21–25	Robust feasibility, allocation, governance.
7. The Fold	26–27	Synchrony, model compatibility, fictional physics.
8. CHOAM in the Crowd	28–30	Resource dependencies and incentives.
9. Old Signals	31–32	Communication codes and uncertain provenance.
10. Candidates	33–35	Independent competence and knowledge limits.
11. The Academy	36–39	Input integrity, motivated reasoning, transfer.
12. Dinner of the Great Schools	40–43	Competing explanations and coordination.
13. Truth Does Not Change	44–48	Leading indicators, fallibilism, power, forecasts.
14. The Order of Atreides	49–51	Multidimensional mastery and qualification.
15. What's Next?	52–53	Adaptive progression and consolidation.
16. Thirty Names	54–59	Provisional placement and cooperative incentives.
17. The Leaflet	60–63	Coalitions, access, generalization limits.
18. The Body Knows First	64–66	Embodiment, observation effects, consent.
19. The Watches	67–70	Estimate–measure calibration and autonomy.
20. Updating	71–74	Multicomponent routine and evidence-based revision.
Epilogue	75–77	Prospective records and hindsight reconstruction.
Appendix I	78	Fictional roster; no participant dataset.
Appendix II	79	Summary of cohort and epistemic rules.
Appendix III	80	Explicit statements of both mathematical problems.
Closing page	81	End matter; no additional scientific claim.

B.2 Source identity

The supplied file is Dune_The_Quiet_Calculus_Book_I_First_Cohort.pdf, 2,359,023 bytes. Its SHA-256 digest is shown in two consecutive halves for readability:

```
23ab20b0f9a31dfc2e92d3e66100076a
4e8db4b90a93f943fc55ca8d9c8f09ba
```

The digest identifies the analyzed bytes; it is not evidence that the narrative events occurred. The local provenance JSON records the original path, PDF metadata, extraction counts, and physical-page convention. The source PDF and synced project material were left unchanged.

B.3 Reproduction instructions

Open `main.tex` as the main document. The project uses standard pdfLaTeX packages and a pre-generated vector PDF figure. The bibliography is included through `references.tex`, so no BibTeX or Biber pass, network access, shell escape, external font download, or Python execution is required to compile. The companion `references.bib` is supplied for future journal conversion but is not part of the current compilation path.

For local compilation, run `python3 scripts/build.py`; it invokes pdfLaTeX three times, retains logs, checks unresolved references and layout diagnostics, and writes `main.pdf`. On Overleaf, upload the supplied ZIP, select `main.tex`, and choose pdfLaTeX. The package is prepared for that workflow; no cloud upload or Overleaf execution was performed during local preparation.

Run `python3 scripts/reproduce.py` to regenerate the numerical JSON, scheduling table, and result macros. Run `python3 scripts/reproduce.py -figures` to regenerate the vector figure, which additionally requires ReportLab. Run `python3 scripts/generate_catalogue.py` to regenerate the catalogue from its plain-text data file. Recompile after regenerating inputs. The calculations use declared finite scenarios and no random sampling.

B.4 Verification boundaries

The supplied verification record separates compilation success, cross-reference resolution, numerical checks, source identity, and visual page review. These are artifact checks. The mathematical propositions are conditional derivations; the human-study designs remain untested proposals. The presence of a formatted scientific manuscript, a clean build, or a reproducible example does not establish scientific validation or publication.

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